MARKETING COURSE · FINAL PROJECT

Market Research

Egypt Tourism App

Market · Competitors · Customers · PEST · SWOT
Final research submission · October 2026

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1. Introduction

Our app is a tourism app for Egypt, built for two groups at the same time: Egyptians who want to travel inside their own country, and foreign tourists coming to visit. It covers all of Egypt, not just Cairo, Luxor and the Red Sea.

Users can pick a ready-made trip or build their own, with places, activities, a halal hotel, transport and a tour guide if they want one. Everyone is verified, every place is halal, and every trip earns rewards.

We did this research because we want to enter the market well prepared. We wanted to understand the market, the competitors and the customers before launch, so the app has the best possible chance to succeed.

> KEY INSIGHT
>
> People don't always need a new destination; sometimes they need a new experience.

2. Research Problem and Objectives

The problem

Planning a trip in Egypt today is scattered. Egyptians mostly book through Facebook pages they don't fully trust, and foreign tourists jump between maps, booking sites and review platforms that only show a few famous cities. There's no single, trusted app that helps people discover all of Egypt and turn that into a real trip.

What we wanted to find out

Objective	Research question
Know our market	How big is the market, and is it growing?
Know our customers	Who are the customer groups, what do they need, what makes them travel, and what stops them?
Know our competitors	Who are the competitors, and what are they doing?
Find our edge	What do customers use today to plan trips, and why would they choose us instead?

3. How We Did the Research

Method	What we did
Secondary research	Collected market data from official and industry sources: the Central Bank of Egypt, WTTC, IMARC, DataReportal, TGM Research and others
Hands-on competitor testing	Downloaded and tried each competitor app and website ourselves (October 2026)

Method	What we did
Social and trend research	Google Trends to compare interest in destinations, Meta Ad Library to study competitors' ads, and TikTok Creative Center for trending travel content
Customer survey	A Google Forms survey to collect travel habits, budgets, interests and needs from potential users

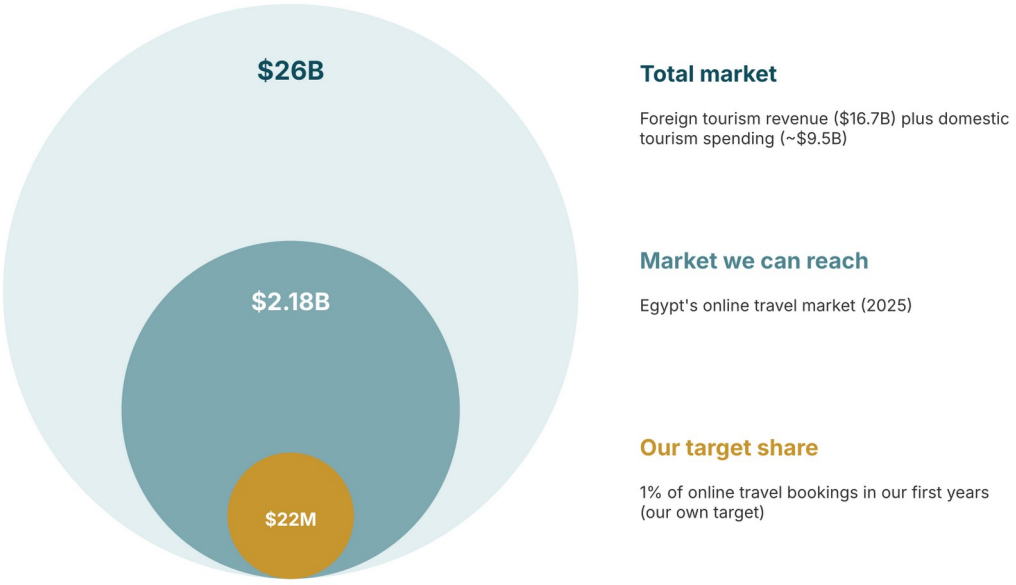
4. The Market

Market size

Tourism in Egypt is big and growing fast:

Indicator	Figure
Foreign tourists	About 19 million in 2025, 21% more than 2024 (15.8 million)
Tourism revenue	$16.7 billion in 2025, up from $14.4 billion in 2024
Egyptians traveling inside Egypt	About EGP 460 billion (~$9.5 billion) in domestic tourism spending in 2025
Tourist nights	154 million nights, about 9–10 nights per tourist
Online travel in Egypt	$2.18 billion in 2025, up from $1.98 billion in 2024
Still mostly offline	Only 22% of hotel bookings are made online; about 70% of flight bookings are still offline
Jobs	Tourism supports 2.9 million jobs
Importance	Around 12% of GDP and the third biggest source of foreign currency

Our share of the market



The 1% target is our own goal, not a published figure.

Growth

- Tourist numbers grew more than 20% in 2025 and kept growing in early 2026 (+15.6% in Q1).
- The government's goal is 30 million tourists a year by 2028.
- Online travel is expected to grow about 10% every year until 2033.
- The Grand Egyptian Museum opening brought a lot of global attention to Egypt.

How the industry works

Player	Examples
Government	Ministry of Tourism and Antiquities: official sites, tickets and the Experience Egypt app
Hotels and resorts	From big Red Sea chains to small eco-lodges in Siwa and Nubia
Travel agencies and tour operators	The traditional way, still very common
Global booking platforms	Booking.com, Airbnb, Tripadvisor, GetYourGuide, Viator
Local apps and startups	Halla, Bokoo, Journeys by Breadfast and others
Informal organizers	Facebook and Instagram pages that sell group trips

How people book today

- Facebook and Instagram pages (very popular with Egyptians)
- Word of mouth from friends and family
- Travel agencies
- Global booking websites (more popular with foreigners)
- Official websites for tickets, also available inside the Vodafone, Orange, e& and WE apps

Customer trends

- People now get travel ideas from social media and online communities more than from agencies.
- Young travelers want personal, authentic experiences, not just the famous sights.
- More interest in hidden places, eco-tourism and nature trips.
- Egyptians are price-sensitive because of inflation; they like paying in EGP with clear prices and no hidden fees.
- For foreigners, Egypt is affordable, but trust and safety are big worries.
- Tourists juggle many apps at once (maps, translation, booking) and want one app for everything.

5. Competitor Analysis

We tried the competitors ourselves. Honestly, we didn't find any app that offers our full idea. Some cover parts of it, and these are the closest:

Closest competitors in Egypt

Competitor	What they do	What we found	Our edge
Facebook trip pages (e.g. Geo Travel)	Group trips sold through posts and messages	Where most Egyptians book today. Not professional; trust depends on the page	Verified users, clear details and prices, a report system
Experience Egypt (Ministry)	Official info and tickets for museums and sites	Very poor UI, and the app didn't work when we tried it	A modern app people can rely on
Halla Travel	Hotels, trips, honeymoon packages, activities	Weak UI/UX; only the popular cities	All of Egypt, not just famous spots
Bokoo Travel	Hotels, flights, cars, visas, Nile cruises	A booking service, not trip discovery	Discover and plan the whole trip
Journeys by Breadfast	Hotels and stays, paid in EGP	Only places to stay; strong brand and user base	The full trip, not just somewhere to sleep
Itinfy	Trip planning, stays, tours, transport, AI planning	The broadest overlap with our services	Verified users, halal places, rewards
SIA Egypt / GuideMe Egypt / Rehla	Travel services, local guides, local outings	Each covers one part of the trip	Everything in one trip

Global platforms

Platform	What they're good at	What's missing for us
Google Maps	Navigation and nearby places	No trips, no curation; we won't compete on maps
Tripadvisor	Reviews and recommendations	Foreign view of Egypt; when we asked about safety it said "kind of safe"
Booking.com / Airbnb	Places to stay	Only accommodation
GetYourGuide / Viator	Tours and tickets	Focus on a few famous cities
Wanderlog	Itinerary planning and budgets	Not built for Egypt; no local partners
Almosafer / Wego	Flights, hotels, eSIM, car rental	Barely covers Egypt; a different idea

What this tells us

- No one offers a full trip app for all of Egypt, for both Egyptians and foreigners.
- The official app is weak, which leaves a real gap for a trusted, well-designed app.

- Most local apps only cover popular cities or only do bookings.
- Our biggest real competitor is Facebook pages and word of mouth, not other apps.
- Maps, reviews or itineraries alone aren't unique. Our edge has to come from how we combine them, and from trust.

Why customers would choose us

Reason	What it means
Trust	A professional app with verified users, not random Facebook pages
More details	Clear information, prices and what's included, plus a video of every place
More options	All of Egypt, not just Cairo, Luxor and the Red Sea
Halal	Alcohol-free hotels and halal places only
Made in Egypt	Presenting our country the right way, not through a foreign platform
For everyone	One app for Egyptians and foreign tourists

6. Customer Research

Egyptians (domestic travelers)

- 119 million people, of whom 98.2 million (82.7%) use the internet.
- 51.6 million can be reached on Facebook, 48.8 million adults on TikTok (65.5% of adults) and 21.7 million on Instagram. This is where we should advertise.
- In a 2025 survey of 1,000 Egyptian adults (TGM Research), about 4 in 10 prefer to organize trips themselves, and only 19% use travel agencies or platforms.
- Facebook is a leading source of travel ideas, and budget stays and beach getaways are popular.
- Only 22% of hotel bookings are made online; most Egyptians still book by phone, through pages or through agencies.

Foreign tourists

- About 19 million visitors in 2025, more than half from Europe. Top countries: Germany, Russia, Italy, the UK, Saudi Arabia, France, Spain and Poland. The US sent over 500,000 in 2024.
- Saudi Arabia alone sent 1.5 million tourists who spent about $1.5 billion, half of all Arab visitors.
- They stay 9–10 nights on average, which is plenty of time to plan activities in the app.
- The Pyramids of Giza get 14.7 million visits a year, and the Grand Egyptian Museum is expected to add 5 million.

Why people travel

People travel to escape their routine, relax, find adventure, discover new things and spend time with others. They're drawn to novelty and memorable experiences, so a different experience can make them want to revisit a place they already know.

> **THE REVISIT JOURNEY**
>
> Visit → Experience → Memory → Curiosity → Revisit

What stops them, and how we help

Customer need or pain point	How our app helps
"I've already been there"	New experiences and ready-made trips in categories for the same destination
Planning a trip takes too long	Ready-made trips, or a custom trip built step by step in one app
Hard to match activities to interests and budget	An optional personality test and a full price shown before booking
Not knowing what a place is really like	A video of every place before you go
Unreliable organizers and recommendations	Verified users, a report system and end-of-trip surveys

Customer need or pain point	How our app helps
Switching between too many apps	Places, hotel, transport and guide in one trip

Customer personas

	Nour, the Egyptian explorer	Alex, the foreign visitor
Who	24, lives in Alexandria, travels with friends	30, first trip to Egypt, staying about a week
Today	Finds trips on Facebook pages and isn't sure who to trust	Juggles maps, booking sites and reviews; only finds the famous sites
Needs	Clear prices in EGP, group discounts, new places	A practical plan, clear total cost, reliable information
What wins them	Verified trips, rewards, and something new to do	Videos of places, a full trip in one app, trustworthy partners

Personas are illustrative, based on our research data.

What this means for us

- Egyptians are online and like planning their own trips, but they have no trusted app, so they end up on Facebook.
- Foreigners stay long and spend a lot, but they're stuck with foreign platforms that only show a few cities.
- The app needs Arabic and English at launch, then Russian, German and Italian.

7. PEST Analysis

Political & Legal

GOVERNMENT AND LAW

- The government strongly supports tourism, with a goal of 30M tourists by 2028
- Visa, licensing, consumer protection and payment rules apply
- Organizing our own trips requires the right tourism license
- Storing IDs and passports means following Egypt's Personal Data Protection Law

Economic

MONEY AND COSTS

- Tourism is growing fast, so there are more potential customers
- Inflation and exchange rates affect budgets and supplier prices
- Egyptians want clear EGP prices and options for every budget
- Development, ads and support all cost money

Social

PEOPLE AND CULTURE

- Travel ideas now come from social media
- Young travelers want authentic, personal trips
- Many Egyptian, Arab and Gulf travelers prefer halal, alcohol-free places
- Travelers speak many languages and have different budgets

Technological

TECH AND DATA

- 82.7% of Egyptians are online, and smartphone use is high
- Mobile maps, digital payments and location notifications make our features possible
- Wrong information or old prices can ruin the experience
- Cybersecurity matters, especially with ID data

8. SWOT Analysis

Strengths

INTERNAL

- Ready-made and custom trips in one app
- All of Egypt, for Egyptians and foreigners
- Verified users and a report system build trust
- Halal-only places
- Points and rewards bring people back
- Made in Egypt, for Egypt

Weaknesses

INTERNAL

- New brand with little awareness or trust
- ID or passport at sign-up may put some people off
- Keeping places and prices accurate takes effort
- Depends on partner companies and sponsors
- Needs investment in development and support

Opportunities

EXTERNAL

- Tourism is growing and the market is still mostly offline
- The official app is weak, leaving a gap
- Huge reach on Facebook and TikTok
- Demand for halal, family-friendly travel
- Grand Egyptian Museum and the 30M tourist goal

Threats

EXTERNAL

- Big global platforms with strong brands
- Inflation and exchange-rate changes
- Regional instability can scare off tourists
- People who don't trust booking online
- Data leaks and licensing rules

9. Our Product

Based on what we found, this is what the app offers at launch:

Area	Features
Trips	Ready-made trips in categories, or a custom trip: choose start and end, places, activities, halal hotel, transport at any stage and an optional tour guide. The total price appears at the end
Discovery	A video of every place, an optional personality test, and a map of places to go out nearby
Trust and safety	National ID or passport sign-up, a report system for any guide or place, halal-only partners
Rewards	Points for the end-of-trip survey and a photo, redeemable for rewards or a free trip; group discounts
Partners	Our own trips plus partner tourism companies (we take a percentage); sponsors with nearby notifications
Future	Our own cafés and venues, and sports clubs (never nightclubs)

10. Key Findings

Finding	What we'll do
The market is big, growing and mostly offline	Enter now, while most bookings still happen by phone and on Facebook
No app offers the full idea	Position as the one trusted app for a whole trip anywhere in Egypt
Facebook pages are the real competitor	Lead with trust: verified users, reports, clear prices
Egyptians plan their own trips and live on social media	Market mainly on Facebook, TikTok and Instagram
Foreigners stay long but only see a few cities	Show them the rest of Egypt, in their language
People want new experiences, not just new places	Ready-made trip categories that make old places feel new

Our research shows a clear gap: a large, growing market with no trusted app that covers all of Egypt for both Egyptians and foreigners. That's the gap our app is built to fill.

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- Cairo 360: Journeys by Breadfast
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- Itinfy, SIA Egypt and GuideMe Egypt: official websites and app listings
- Our own hands-on testing of each competitor app and website (October 2026)